

Bridging continents through knowledge, strengthening partnerships









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Foreword

The Chamber of Commerce and Industry of India has, over the decades, played a catalytic role in fostering India's economic diplomacy with partner nations across the globe. Latin America, and Ecuador in particular, represents an emerging frontier of opportunity for Indian industry one that remains under-explored relative to its potential. This Knowledge Paper is a deliberate step towards correcting that imbalance.

Ecuador's dollarised and relatively stable macroeconomic framework, its abundant natural resource endowment, its strategic access to Pacific shipping lanes, and its government's stated ambition to diversify beyond hydrocarbons into mining, renewable energy, agro-industry and digital services, together present a compelling proposition for Indian investors and exporters. At the same time, Ecuador's manufacturers, agro-processors and service providers stand to benefit substantially from India's cost-competitive engineering, pharmaceutical, IT and capital goods capabilities.

CCI India remains committed to facilitating this partnership through trade delegations, B2B matchmaking, sectoral working groups and an annual India–Ecuador Business Forum, several of which are outlined in the concluding of this report. We extend our gratitude to the Embassy of Ecuador in India for its close collaboration in the preparation of this Knowledge Paper, and we look forward to translating its findings into concrete commercial outcomes for both nations.



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ECUADOR

> Experience diverse landscapes and traditions at a steady pace



Basic Facts, Demographics, and Monetary System: Ecuador, officially the Republic of Ecuador, is located on the northwestern coast of South America and is bordered by Colombia, Peru, and the Pacific Ocean. Its capital is Quito, the official language is Spanish, and the country uses the U.S. Dollar (USD) as its official currency.

Ecuador has a population of over 18 million people and is known for its geographic diversity, including the Andes, Amazon rainforest, Pacific coast, and Galápagos Islands.

Economy and GDP

Ecuador has a diversified upper-middle-income economy supported by petroleum, agriculture, manufacturing, trade, and services. In 2024, Ecuador's nominal GDP stood at approximately USD 124.68 billion. Oil remains one of the country's most important export earners, while bananas, shrimp, cocoa, flowers, and mining products are also major contributors. Although Ecuador's economy contracted by 1.9 % in 2024, exports continued to contribute positively, reflecting resilience in external trade sectors.

Bilateral Trade and Economic Ties with India

India and Ecuador maintain growing trade relations centered on pharmaceuticals, chemicals, machinery, vehicles, and industrial goods from India, while Ecuador exports petroleum-related products, minerals, agricultural produce, and seafood. Economic cooperation is expanding in pharmaceuticals, energy, mining, agriculture, and technical trade partnerships.

Bilateral Trade with India (in Billions)

Bilateral trade between India and Ecuador is valued at approximately USD 1.26 billion annually, reflecting steady growth in commercial engagement between both countries.



Culture and Heritage

Ecuador's culture reflects a blend of Indigenous, Spanish, and Afro-Ecuadorian influences expressed through traditional festivals, music, dance, handicrafts, and cuisine. Its rich heritage is also reflected in its historic colonial cities, Indigenous markets, and globally renowned Galápagos-linked ecological identity.